

Community Audio Broadcast — Marketing and Sales Solution

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Taking the channel to 100 institutions in two years as a social enterprise, funded by institution subscriptions, CSR and grants, and household micro-contributions.

Positioning

"Your community hears you at home — clearly, every time, without disturbing anyone who did not ask to listen."

That is the whole pitch, and the second half is as important as the first. It is what makes the product sellable to an institution, fundable by a corporate, and defensible in a neighbourhood.

What this is sold as

Frame	To whom	Why it lands
Reaching everyone, not just those outdoors	Institution head	The loudspeaker misses people indoors, at work, elderly, and anyone beyond the sound cone. This reaches all of them
A register of who you actually reached	Committee, secretary	For the first time the institution knows, household by household. Nobody has ever had this
Good neighbourliness	Committee, local authority, funders	The same message, heard by those who want it, not imposed on those who do not
Continuity	Institution head, quietly	If loudspeaker permission narrows, contact does not stop
Digital inclusion for elderly and low-income households	CSR and grant funders	A ₹300 device that reaches people no app has ever reached

What this must never be sold as

This is the part that decides whether the company survives contact with the press.

- **Never as a way around noise regulation.** The moment the pitch is "beat the azaan ban", the product becomes a political object, every institution that buys it is making a statement, and no corporate will fund it. The channel is additive, the loudspeaker stays, and the institution's compliance posture is unchanged.
- **Never as a religious product.** It is community audio infrastructure. The same system serves a masjid, a parish, a gurdwara and a village panchayat. Faith-neutral by construction — which also means never building a feature that only one faith can use.
- **Never as surveillance.** The delivery report tells an institution that a household connected. It must never become who listened to what, for how long. Say this out loud, early, in writing.
- **Never as a replacement for the loudspeaker.** Institutions are attached to the loudspeaker, it works, and telling a committee to give it up loses the deal in the first meeting.

Competitive position

There is no direct competitor. What the institution is actually choosing between:

Alternative	Why it loses
Doing nothing, loudspeaker only	Works today, costs nothing. This is the real competitor and it wins most deals
A WhatsApp group	Free, already exists, but text not voice, misses the elderly entirely, and nobody knows who saw it
Recording and sending an audio file	Not live, no adhan, no reach to feature phones
A YouTube or Facebook live stream	Public rather than members-only, needs a smartphone and confidence, and puts the institution's content on someone else's platform
A bigger, louder PA system	Makes the underlying problem worse

The competitor to beat is inertia. The sales job is not differentiation against a rival, it is creating urgency where a working loudspeaker removes it. Everything in the go-to-market that follows is shaped by that single fact.

Market and segments

India's Census 2001 counted [2.37 million places of worship](#). Estimates put the number of [mosques between 300,000 and 400,000](#), second or third in the world; India's [27.8 million Christians](#) are served by tens of thousands of parishes, concentrated in Kerala (6.14 m), Tamil Nadu (4.42 m) and the North East.

The number that matters is much smaller. The target is 100 institutions in two years.

Funnel from total to addressable

	Institutions	Filter applied
All places of worship in India	~2,400,000	—
Mosques and churches with an organised congregation	~400,000	Excludes shrines and unstaffed sites
With a functioning loudspeaker and an active weekly rhythm	~250,000	The product only makes sense where there is already something to broadcast
With a managing committee able to approve ₹1–4 lakh	~60,000	The hard financial filter
In districts with adequate broadband and smartphone penetration	~25,000	T1 and T2 must cover most households
Realistically reachable in 5 years through the channels available	~2,000	Federation relationships and installer coverage
Target, 2 years	100	

The serviceable market is large enough that it is not the constraint. Channel capacity and capital are.

Segment priority

Segment	Size signal	Why here first / why not
Urban and peri-urban mosques, 300–800 households	Large; active loudspeaker use; five daily slots	Start here. Highest value from the product, clearest continuity motivation, organised committees, dense installer coverage

Segment	Size signal	Why here first / why not
Kerala and Tamil Nadu parishes	10.5 m Christians between them; high literacy and broadband	Start here too. Diocesan structures make one relationship unlock many parishes; high smartphone penetration lowers the T3 share
North East churches	2.2 m in Meghalaya, 1.7 m in Nagaland; very high Christian share	Later. Strong community cohesion but thinner broadband and harder logistics
Rural mosques and churches, under 200 households	Enormous	Later. Lower ability to pay, higher T3 share, worse economics per install
Gurdwaras, temples, village panchayats	Large	Opportunistic. Same technology, different rhythm; useful for the faith-neutral positioning but not a focused motion
Institutions with members abroad	Niche but wealthy	High willingness to pay; diaspora often funds the capital outright

Where the first hundred come from

Not spread across India. Two districts, deeply.

- **Institutions 1–5:** one district, chosen because a federation or diocese there will vouch for the pilot. Hand-held, heavily supported, and used to build every piece of evidence the rest of the plan needs.
- **Institutions 6–30:** the same district plus one adjacent, through the federation relationship and the first installer partners. This is where onboarding time must fall from weeks to days.
- **Institutions 31–100:** two to three more districts in the same state, plus the first institutions won purely by referral. A second state only if the first is clearly working.

Density beats coverage at this stage. Installer partners need enough local volume to care, field support needs short travel, and referral only works between institutions that know each other. A hundred institutions across twenty states would be unsupportable and would prove nothing.

The number that actually sizes the business

Not institutions — **households reached**. At 100 institutions and 400 households each, that is **40,000 households, around 180,000 people**. That is the figure a CSR committee evaluates, the figure a grant is written against, and the figure that should appear on the first slide of every funding conversation.

The buyer and the decision unit

Nobody here is a procurement professional. The decision is made by volunteers, in the evening, in a room, by consensus — and anyone in that room can quietly kill it.

Person	Role in the decision	What they care about	What loses them
Institution head — imam, priest, pastor	Champion. Without them there is no deal	Reaching the whole community; dignity; that this does not change how worship sounds	Anything implying the loudspeaker is a problem, or that technology mediates worship
Committee president / trustee	Approves the money	Whether the community will actually use it; not looking foolish if it fails	No evidence; no reference they can call
Treasurer	The quiet veto	Recurring cost with no recurring funding	A subscription with no answer to "who pays this next year"
Secretary / clerk	Does the work; becomes the roster keeper	Whether this adds to their workload forever	Anything that means maintaining a second register by hand
Young tech-capable member	Technical validator, often self-appointed	Whether it actually works; whether they could build it cheaper	Hand-waving. Answer them properly; they become the strongest advocate
The muezzin or the person who speaks	Informal veto, easily overlooked	That nothing about their microphone changes	Any change to the audio chain they can hear
Elderly members	Whose adoption decides renewal	That it is simple and free	A device with menus, or a monthly bill

The two people most often missed

The treasurer. Sales conversations focus on the head, who is enthusiastic, and the president, who approves. The treasurer says nothing in the meeting and then asks one question afterwards that stops it: how is this paid for in year three. The household micro-contribution model exists largely to answer that question, and it should be introduced in the first meeting, not the third.

The muezzin. A five-minute conversation and a demonstration that his microphone is untouched converts the person best placed to sabotage the project into the person who tests it every day.

Sales cycle

Stage	Typical duration	What has to happen
Introduction	1-2 weeks	Through a federation, an installer, or another institution — almost never cold
First meeting with the head	1 meeting	Demonstrate live audio on a phone, in the room. Nothing persuades like hearing it
Committee presentation	2-6 weeks	Depends entirely on when the committee next meets
Reference check	1-3 weeks	They will call another institution. This is why density matters
Approval and deposit	2-4 weeks	
Total	2-4 months	Faster with a federation endorsement; slower without a reference

Committees meet monthly at best. The cycle is governed by their calendar, not by sales effort, which means pipeline has to be built three months ahead and no amount of pushing compresses it.

What closes the deal

In rough order of power: another institution the committee trusts saying it works; the head hearing the audio live in the room on their own phone; a clear answer on who pays in year three; a named local person who will handle installs and faults; and a funded first year. Product features appear nowhere on that list.

Pricing and packaging

Three revenue lines: a one-time kit, a monthly subscription, and hardware sold at or near cost. The subscription is where the business lives; the hardware is deliberately not a profit centre, because every rupee on the box price suppresses the household adoption that decides renewal.

Packages

	Basic	Pro
Monthly subscription	₹3,000	₹6,000
Annual, paid up front	₹33,000 (1 month free)	₹66,000
Households included	up to 500	up to 1,000
Live broadcast, unlimited slots	Yes	Yes
Prayer timetable and scheduling	Yes	Yes
Per-household slot and volume control	Yes	Yes
Delivery reports	Yes	Yes
Recording and 12-month archive	—	Yes
Replay in app and by dial-in	—	Yes
Native app with push	—	Yes
Transcript and translation	—	Yes
Redundant encoder	—	Yes
Support	Email and WhatsApp, 1 business day	Phone, 4 hours

One-time and pass-through

Item	Price	Note
Institution kit — encoder, interface, UPS, 4G router, console	₹55,000	Cost ₹40,500. Installed and commissioned by a partner
Kit on lease, instead of purchase	₹1,800/month, 36 months	Removes the capital barrier; the single most effective concession available
Parish Box	₹300 to the household, or ₹285 in bulk to the institution	At cost. Not a margin line until volume brings BOM to ₹186

Item	Price	Note
Voice minutes	At cost + 10%	Passed through, metered, hard-capped per institution
SMS and WhatsApp notifications	At cost + 10%	
Enrolment campaign support	₹25,000	Optional. Two weekends, materials, volunteer training. Worth pushing hard — it is what makes the institution succeed

Does the price work against what they already spend?

Their existing spend	Typical annual	Our Basic annual
Loudspeaker system maintenance and electricity	₹15,000–30,000	₹36,000
A single PA amplifier replacement	₹25,000–60,000 one-time	₹55,000 kit one-time
Printing and distributing notices	₹10,000–25,000	—
Community events budget	₹1–5 lakh	—

₹3,000 a month is real money for a small institution and unremarkable for a mid-sized one. **It is roughly what a masjid or parish spends on electricity.** That is the comparison to use, because it reframes the subscription from a new expense into a utility.

Discounting policy

Situation	Concession	Never
First 10 institutions	100% subsidised by grant capital, in exchange for reference rights and case-study participation	Undisclosed free deals that poison later pricing
Federation signing 10+ institutions	20% off subscription, kit at cost	Free subscription in perpetuity

Situation	Concession	Never
Genuine inability to pay	Grant-funded place, formally applied for and recorded as a funded institution	Quiet price cuts that make the next negotiation harder
Long sales cycle stalling on capital	Kit lease at ₹1,800/month	Dropping the subscription

Hold the subscription price and concede on capital. The kit is a one-time barrier that a lease dissolves; the subscription is the recurring revenue that the entire business model depends on. An institution that never pays a subscription is not a customer, it is a grant recipient, and it should be recorded and funded as one.

Price review

Revisit after institution 25. The two signals that say the price is wrong: deals closing without any negotiation at all means it is too low; the treasurer being the blocker in more than a third of deals means it is too high, or the household contribution story is not being told early enough.

Unit economics

Each institution is profitable from about month eighteen. The organisation is not profitable at 100 institutions, and pretending otherwise is the fastest way to run out of money in year three.

Per institution, per year, at 100 institutions

Line	Basic	Pro
Subscription	₹36,000	₹72,000
Hardware margin, annualised over 5 years	₹4,640	₹4,640
Kit margin, annualised	₹2,900	₹2,900
Revenue	₹43,540	₹79,540
Platform cost — streaming, compute, storage	₹2,460	₹3,300
Support and field operations, allocated	₹10,800	₹14,400
Monitoring, backups, security	₹840	₹840
Cost to serve	₹14,100	₹18,540

Line	Basic	Pro
Contribution	₹29,440	₹61,000

Voice minutes and notifications are passed through at cost + 10% and are excluded above; they neither help nor hurt materially. At a 70/30 Basic-to-Pro mix, blended contribution is about **₹38,900 per institution per year**.

Acquisition cost

Line	Direct sale	Via federation	Via installer partner
Field time, 2-4 month cycle	₹25,000	₹8,000	₹3,000
Partner commission	—	—	₹12,000
Enrolment campaign support	₹20,000	₹20,000	₹20,000
Commissioning	₹8,000	₹8,000	₹3,000 (partner does it)
CAC	₹53,000	₹36,000	₹38,000
Payback at blended contribution	~16 months	~11 months	~12 months

The federation route is the cheapest and the installer route is close behind. Direct sales exist to open a district, not to fill it.

The number nobody wants to write down

	Value
Fixed annual cost — team of 7, office, R&D, compliance	₹1.4 crore
Blended contribution per institution	₹38,900
Institutions needed to break even	~360
Institutions at end of year 2	100
Contribution at 100 institutions	₹39 lakh
Annual deficit at 100 institutions	≈ ₹1 crore

100 institutions is a proof point, not a business. Break-even is around 360 institutions, which on this trajectory is year four or five. The two years to 100 must be funded by grant and CSR capital, and the funding case has to be made on that basis openly rather than on a hockey stick nobody believes.

Levers that move break-even

Lever	Break-even moves to	Cost of pulling it
Raise Basic to ₹4,000/month	~280 institutions	Treasurer resistance rises; test at institution 25
Shift mix to 50% Pro	~300 institutions	Needs Pro built and proven, which is year 2
Hold the team at 5 rather than 7	~260 institutions	Slower build; field support strain
Push all field work to installer partners	~290 institutions	Commission cost, but removes the support line that does not scale
Grow to 500 households average per institution	~330 institutions	Targeting larger institutions from the start

Combining the realistic ones — a modest price rise, partner-led field operations and a disciplined team — puts break-even near **220 institutions**, which is reachable in year three. That is the plan worth funding, and it is worth building the pricing test into institution 25 rather than discovering it at institution 80.

Funding strategy

About **₹5 crore over three years** gets this to 100 institutions and within sight of break-even. It comes from four pockets with different rules, and the structure of the entity has to accommodate all four.

Capital requirement

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Total
Team	₹85 L	₹1.30 Cr	₹1.45 Cr	₹3.60 Cr
Hardware working capital, peak	₹12 L	₹37 L	₹55 L	—
Tooling, certification, test jig	₹3 L	₹3 L	—	₹6 L

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Total
Infrastructure and tools	₹5 L	₹8 L	₹12 L	₹25 L
Field operations and enrolment	₹8 L	₹25 L	₹40 L	₹73 L
Subsidised institutions (first 10, then hardship places)	₹5 L	₹15 L	₹20 L	₹40 L
Compliance, legal, audit	₹4 L	₹6 L	₹8 L	₹18 L
Gross requirement	₹1.10 Cr	₹1.87 Cr	₹2.25 Cr	₹5.22 Cr
Less revenue	₹2 L	₹25 L	₹85 L	₹1.12 Cr
Net capital needed	₹1.08 Cr	₹1.62 Cr	₹1.40 Cr	₹4.10 Cr

The four pockets

Source	Realistic size	Buys	Constraint
Corporate CSR	₹25 L-1 Cr per corporate	Funded institutions, hardware batches, enrolment campaigns	Must map to a Schedule VII head; annual cycle; needs verified impact reporting
Philanthropic grants	₹50 L-2 Cr	Team, R&D, the unprofitable early years	Long diligence; want evidence and a theory of change
Impact / blended capital	₹1-3 Cr	Hardware working capital, scale-up	Wants a path to sustainability, which is the 220-institution number
Revenue	₹1.1 Cr over 3 years	Itself	Grows slowly; cannot fund the build

Why CSR fits, specifically

Indian listed companies spent [₹22,563 crore on CSR in FY25](#), up 17.5%, across 2,013 companies. Education and skilling took ₹9,182 crore (41%), healthcare ₹5,386 crore, and rural development ₹1,632 crore. The market is large, growing, and chronically short of projects that can prove delivery.

This project's advantage is that it **evidences reach at household granularity as a by-product of running normally**. Most community-media interventions report attendance estimates. This one reports, per household, per broadcast, whether audio was delivered — signed, dated, and auditable. For a CSR committee that has to defend its spending, that is unusual and valuable.

Framing for CSR, by Schedule VII head:

Head	Framing	Strength
Promoting education, including elderly	Community information access for households with no digital reach	Strong — the largest CSR pool
Reducing inequalities faced by socially and economically backward groups	Elderly, low-income and non-smartphone households reached for ₹300	Strong
Rural development projects	Where deployed in rural districts	Moderate
Environmental sustainability	Noise pollution reduction	Weak alone; useful as a secondary point

One caution. A CSR committee will look carefully at anything that reads as funding religious activity, which is not a permitted CSR head. The proposal must be written around **community information infrastructure and digital inclusion**, with the institution as the delivery channel rather than the beneficiary. This is true rather than cosmetic — the same system serves a panchayat — but it has to be said in the funder's language and evidenced with a faith-neutral deployment or two.

Named funder types to approach

- **Corporates with large rural or small-town footprints** — banking and financial services (₹5,066 crore of CSR in FY25, the largest sector), telecom, FMCG, cement. Telecom is the most natural fit and the most likely to have a competing internal view.
- **Indian philanthropic foundations** working on technology access, elderly welfare, and community media.
- **Impact investors and incubators** focused on early-stage Indian social ventures with hardware components.
- **State minority welfare and social justice departments**, and **waqf boards**, which hold their own funds and are also a distribution channel.

- **Diaspora giving**, institution by institution — often the fastest capital available for a specific institution's kit, though not for the platform.

Entity structure

A hybrid structure is what makes all four pockets reachable: an operating company that earns subscription revenue, and a Section 8 company or trust that receives CSR and grant funds and pays for funded institutions, enrolment campaigns and hardship places. The two must have a clean, documented, arm's-length relationship, because a funder's diligence will look directly at it and a muddled structure has killed better ventures than this one.

Household micro-contribution

This is the single most important commercial mechanism in the plan. **₹20 a month from each household makes the institution comfortably cash-positive on the whole system**, which turns the treasurer from the blocker into the advocate.

The arithmetic

	Per month	Per year
500 households at ₹20	₹10,000	₹1,20,000
Subscription, Basic	₹3,000	₹36,000
Voice and notifications, passed through	₹2,100	₹25,200
Box replacement fund, 5% of fleet	₹600	₹7,200
Institution surplus	₹4,300	₹51,600

Even at a **50% participation rate and ₹20**, the institution collects ₹60,000 a year and covers its subscription and voice with room to spare. At ₹10 and 70% participation it roughly breaks even. The model is robust to both the amount and the take-up being much lower than hoped, which is exactly the property a treasurer needs to hear.

Why this works here and not elsewhere

Religious institutions in India already run voluntary contribution systems — *chanda*, tithe, offerings, festival collections — with established norms, existing collectors and social expectations. This is not a new payment behaviour being introduced; it is a new line item in an old one. A household that already puts money in a box weekly will not find ₹20 a month strange.

The contrast is instructive: a startup asking 500 households for ₹20 a month directly would spend more on collection than it raised. The institution asking the same households, in the same way it always has, costs nothing.

How it is framed

Correct framing: "The community's channel is run by the community." Announced by the institution head, as a voluntary contribution toward keeping it running, alongside the existing collection.

Fatal framings, all of which must be avoided:

- A subscription fee. The moment it is a fee, non-payment means exclusion, and excluding a household from hearing the adhan is unthinkable. It must remain voluntary, and households that do not contribute must keep receiving.
- A per-device charge. Ties money to hardware and makes the box feel like a rental.
- Collected by the platform. The institution collects. The platform never appears in a household's payment.
- Mandatory for the elderly or the poor. These are the households the system exists for.

Mechanics

Element	Approach
Collection	By the institution, however it already collects — cash box, UPI to the institution's own account, annual pledge
Frequency	Annual pledge is easier to collect than monthly, and this is well understood by every treasurer
Tracking	The platform's roster carries a contributed-or-not flag so the clerk does not keep a second register. No amounts, no payment processing
Non-contributors	Receive everything. No difference in service, no reminder from the platform, ever
Transparency	The institution publishes annually what was collected and what it cost. This is how voluntary systems sustain themselves

What this means for the sales conversation

Introduce it in the **first** meeting, not when the treasurer objects. The line is roughly:

"The committee approves the setup. After that, if about half the households give ₹20 a month — the way they already give — the channel pays for itself and leaves something over for repairs. We will show you the numbers for your own household count."

This does three things at once: answers who pays in year three, proves the venture is not extracting from a community, and hands the committee a decision they know how to make. It converts an unfamiliar SaaS purchase into a familiar community-funding decision, and that is why it belongs at the front of the pitch rather than the back.

Go-to-market motion

flowchart LR

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A[Warm intro] --> B[Head meeting<br/>live demo]
B --> C[Committee<br/>presentation]
C --> D[Reference call]
D --> E[Approval<br/>+ deposit]
E --> F[Commission<br/>2 days]
F --> G[Enrolment<br/>campaign]
G --> H[First 90 days<br/>managed]
H --> I[Referral ask]
I --> A

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The loop closes deliberately. Every institution that reaches day 90 successfully is the introduction for the next two, which is the only acquisition motion that gets cheaper with scale.

Stage by stage

Stage	Owner	Duration	Exit condition
Warm introduction	Federation, installer, or a live institution	1–2 weeks	A named meeting with the head
Head meeting	Field lead	1 meeting	The head has heard live audio on their own phone and agreed to take it to the committee
Committee presentation	Field lead + the head	2–6 weeks	Approval in principle; treasurer's question answered with their own household numbers

Stage	Owner	Duration	Exit condition
Reference call	Another institution's committee	1-3 weeks	Nothing we can control. Make it easy and get out of the way
Approval and deposit	Institution	2-4 weeks	Signed agreement, deposit received before hardware is ordered
Commissioning	Installer partner	2 days	Kit live, test broadcast heard by the head
Enrolment campaign	Institution, supported	3-4 weekends	≥ 60% of households enrolled
First 90 days	Field lead	90 days	12 consecutive weeks of broadcasts, ≥ 85% reach, ≤ 3% endpoints dark
Referral ask	Field lead	Day 90	Two named introductions

The demo

The entire first meeting turns on one thing: the head hears their own voice arrive on a phone across the room, three seconds later. Carry a portable kit — a small interface, a laptop, a mobile hotspot, two Parish Boxes. Plug into their own mixer if they allow it, speak into their own microphone, and let them watch a box in the corner light up and play.

No slides until after this has happened. A committee that has heard it needs a decision; a committee that has only seen a deck needs another meeting.

First 90 days is part of the sale

Most of the churn risk in this business sits in the first quarter. An institution that reaches week twelve with good reach numbers almost never leaves; one that limps through enrolment quietly stops broadcasting by month five and cancels at renewal.

So the first 90 days is a managed engagement, not a support ticket queue: weekly reach numbers sent to the head, a volunteer visit list generated automatically from dark endpoints, and one check-in call a month with the committee. It is expensive — it is most of the ₹20,000 enrolment support line — and it is the highest-return spend in the whole plan.

What does not work

- **Cold outreach.** Institutions do not respond to unknown vendors. Everything is warm or it does not happen.
- **Digital-first marketing.** The buyer is a committee in a room, not a lead form.
- **Selling the technology.** The committee does not care about Opus or latency. The young technical member does, and he gets his own conversation.
- **Trying to shorten the committee cycle.** It cannot be shortened; it can only be started earlier.
- **Selling one institution in each of ten districts.** No reference density, no installer economics, no referrals. Density or nothing.

Channel 1 — federations and religious bodies

One relationship can unlock thirty institutions. It can also consume a year and deliver nothing, which is why this channel is run in parallel with the others rather than depended on.

Who they are

Body	Span	Nature of authority
Catholic diocese	50–200 parishes	Genuinely hierarchical. A bishop's endorsement carries real weight with parish priests
Protestant denominational synod or council	50–500 congregations	Varies from directive to purely advisory
State waqf board	Hundreds of registered properties	Regulatory and financial rather than spiritual; also a potential funder
Jamaat federation or masjid association	20–200 mosques	Peer association. Influence is by respect, not instruction
Regional community trusts	10–50 institutions	Often the practical decision-maker for a cluster

The distinction between **directive** and **advisory** bodies is the one that matters. A diocese can effectively decide for its parishes. A masjid federation cannot decide for anyone — but a recommendation from it removes the risk objection from every conversation that follows, which is most of the value anyway.

What they need to say yes

Concern	What answers it
"Will this embarrass us?"	A working institution they can visit, and a clear public position on noise regulation
"Is this a commercial outfit extracting from our community?"	Social enterprise structure, hardware at cost, contribution model that keeps money inside the institution
"Who pays?"	Funded places for institutions that cannot afford it, secured before the conversation
"What do we get?"	The federation view — adoption across their institutions, aggregate reach, nothing household-level
"Will it work in our smaller places?"	Honest answer: below 200 households the economics are harder. Do not oversell
"What about our theological concerns?"	Recorded adhan is off by default; the institution controls everything; the platform touches no content

The offer

Element	Terms
Federation agreement	10+ institutions over 24 months
Pricing	20% off subscription, institution kit at cost
Funded places	2 fully grant-funded institutions per 10 committed, chosen by the federation
Federation dashboard	Aggregate adoption and reach across their institutions. No household data, stated explicitly in the agreement
Joint branding	The federation's endorsement on materials; their name in funder reporting if they permit
Named liaison	One person on our side who answers their calls

The funded places are what converts interest into commitment. A federation that can place two institutions that could never have afforded this has a reason to move, and those two become the internal reference cases that sell the other eight.

How to approach

1. **Never start at the top.** An unsolicited approach to a bishop or a board chair goes nowhere. Start with one institution inside that federation, make it work, and let its head make the introduction.
2. **Bring a peer, not a pitch.** The best first meeting has the head of the working institution in the room.
3. **Ask for a pilot cluster, not an endorsement.** Three institutions they choose, funded, over six months. An endorsement asked for too early is refused and then difficult to revisit.
4. **Expect the pace to be theirs.** These bodies meet quarterly or annually. Build the relationship a year ahead of when the deals are needed.
5. **Accept advisory outcomes.** A federation that will let you present at its annual gathering and will not object to being named has given you most of what you need.

Risks specific to this channel

- **Single-point dependency.** A change of bishop or board chair can end a relationship overnight. Never let one federation exceed a third of the pipeline.
- **Exclusivity requests.** A federation may ask to be the only body in a region. Decline politely; it caps the market and creates a dependency.
- **Politicisation.** A federation may want to use the product as a statement about noise regulation. That is precisely the framing the positioning rules out, and it is worth losing the relationship over.
- **Slow and silent.** Federations rarely say no. They simply do not schedule the next meeting. Time-box the effort and keep the other two channels running.

Channel 2 — local installer partners

The people who installed the institution's loudspeakers are the right channel. They already know the buyer, they are already trusted, they are already in the building once a year, and they are the only economically viable way to do 40 field visits a week at 100 institutions.

Who they are

Small PA, CCTV and electrical contractors — typically two to eight people, one or two vans, covering a few blocks or a taluk. They install and maintain public address systems, security cameras, intercoms and inverters for schools, shops, halls and places of worship. Their business is one-time installation revenue with thin recurring maintenance, and **recurring revenue is what they want and rarely get.**

Partner economics

Line	Per institution
Referral and close commission	₹12,000 one-time
Kit commissioning fee	₹8,000 one-time
Box installation, 150 boxes at ₹60	₹9,000 one-time
Annual service retainer	₹18,000/year recurring
Box swaps and callouts, ~20/year at ₹400	₹8,000/year recurring
Year 1 to the partner	₹55,000
Year 2 onward, recurring	₹26,000/year

A partner with ten institutions earns about **₹2.6 lakh a year in recurring revenue** on top of installation fees — material for a business of this size, and enough that they defend the relationship. That recurring line is the whole design of this channel: a partner paid only on installs will sell and disappear, and the field support model collapses.

What we provide

Training	Two days initial, one day annually. Commissioning, provisioning, triage, and how to talk to a committee
Certification	Tiered — installer, then service partner, then sales partner. Public listing
Tools	Partner app: assigned jobs, remote device diagnostics, provisioning, job completion
Stock	Consignment spares held at the partner, reconciled quarterly

Sales support	Our field lead joins any committee meeting they ask for, for the first three institutions
Leads	Institutions we source in their territory go to them

Recruiting

Find them through the institutions themselves — every institution can name who maintains its loudspeakers, and that is the shortlist. Start with the partner serving the pilot institution.

Qualify on: existing work with places of worship, a service mentality rather than pure project work, willingness to be trained, and at least one person who can hold a conversation with a committee. Technical skill is the easy part; most of these businesses can wire anything. The constraint is whether they can be trusted in someone's home, because that is what box installation is.

Target density: 3–5 active partners per district, 10–20 institutions each. Fewer than three and there is no resilience; more than five and none of them gets enough volume to care.

Managing the channel

Control	Mechanism
Quality	Install success rate and 90-day endpoint-dark rate per partner, visible to them
Territory	Non-exclusive, but leads routed to the partner with the best local record
Escalation	Any institution can escalate past its partner to us directly, always
Price discipline	Partners do not set prices. Published pricing, no negotiation at partner level
Offboarding	Written criteria, stock reconciliation, institutions reassigned without service gap

The risk to watch

A partner who oversells — promising the loudspeaker can be switched off, or that the box works without Wi-Fi — does damage that takes a year to repair, in a market that runs entirely on word of mouth. Certification should include what not to say, and the first three

institutions of any new partner should be jointly attended for exactly this reason.

Channel 3 — community referral

The cheapest channel and the only one that compounds. It is also entirely downstream of whether institutions actually succeed, which makes it a product outcome rather than a marketing programme.

Why institutions talk to each other

Heads of institutions in a district know each other. They meet at funerals, festivals, civic occasions and federation gatherings. When one has solved a problem the others recognise, it comes up without prompting — and "we reach every house now, even the old people who never came" is exactly the kind of thing that gets mentioned.

But it only happens if the institution is genuinely succeeding. An institution at 45% reach does not talk about it. **The referral channel is fed by the 90-day reach number and by nothing else.**

Engineering the referral

Mechanism	How
The day-90 ask	A formal part of the engagement, not an afterthought: "Which two institutions should hear about this?" Asked when the reach numbers are good and the head is pleased
Visit hosting	Prospective committees visit a live institution. The host head explains it far better than any salesperson. Budget ₹5,000 per hosted visit for hospitality
The reach certificate	A simple, dated, signed one-page report the institution can show anyone: households enrolled, households reached, broadcasts delivered. Heads share these
Festival and gathering presence	Where institutions convene, with the host institution's head, never as an exhibitor
No cash referral fees	A head who gets paid for a referral loses the credibility that made the referral valuable. Recognition, hosted visits and priority support instead

What referral cannot do

It cannot open a new district — institutions refer within their own network, which is geographically and denominationally bounded. It cannot be accelerated by incentives. And it goes into reverse very efficiently: one visibly failing institution in a district suppresses every conversation in it. This is the strongest commercial argument for the expensive first-90-days programme.

Household activation

Selling the institution takes four months and produces nothing. Enrolling its households takes four weekends and produces everything. **Enrolment is the product**, and treating it as a post-sale implementation detail is the most likely way this venture fails quietly.

Why it decides everything

Reach at day 90	What follows
Above 85%	Head is delighted, referrals flow, renewal is automatic, contribution collection works
60–85%	Renewal is a conversation. No referrals. Contribution collection underperforms
Below 60%	Broadcasting quietly stops by month five. Cancellation at renewal. The district is poisoned

The gap between these outcomes is not the technology — it is identical in all three. It is whether 500 households were actually signed up, equipped and tested.

The enrolment campaign

Three to four consecutive weekends, immediately after commissioning, while the announcement from the pulpit or minbar is still fresh.

Weekend	Activity	Target
0	Institution head announces the channel and why. Not a vendor, not a volunteer — the head	Everyone present hears it
1	Enrolment desk after services. Name, address cluster, numbers, tier choice, consent signed. T1 households leave with the link working on their phone	40% of households
2	Repeat desk. Box home-visit bookings begin. First T3 test calls placed same day	60% cumulative
3	Repeat desk plus box installs. Head names the households still missing, from the pulpit	75% cumulative
4–8	Volunteer door-to-door for the remainder; one visit each, no chasing	85% cumulative

What makes it work

The head's personal endorsement. Nothing else comes close. A head who announces it once and delegates the rest gets 40% enrolment; a head who mentions it for four consecutive weeks gets 85%.

Enrol where they already are. After services, at the institution. A door-to-door-first campaign costs five times more and reaches fewer.

Demonstrate before they leave. A T1 household that walks away with a link they have not heard working will not open it. Play something. Thirty seconds.

Test T3 the same day. Phone numbers are written down wrong constantly. A test call placed while the person is still at the desk catches it; a test call the following week does not reach anyone who can fix it.

Name the gap publicly. By weekend three the head naming the streets or families not yet enrolled does more than any volunteer.

What breaks it

- A vendor running the desk instead of the institution's own people.
- Charging ₹300 for the box at the desk. Take the contribution later, separately, as a community contribution — never as a price at the point of enrolment.
- Enrolling without a consent signature, which makes the household unreachable on the voice tier and creates a compliance problem later.
- Letting box installs lag enrolment by more than two weeks. Enthusiasm decays fast.
- Starting enrolment before the system is actually live. A failed demo at the desk ends the campaign.

The numbers to watch after launch

Metric	Healthy	What it means
Households enrolled / total	≥ 85%	The campaign worked
Reach per broadcast / enrolled	≥ 90%	The technology is working
Endpoints dark, 30-day	≤ 3%	Field support is keeping up
Households with volume at zero	≤ 2%	Early disengagement — the leading indicator of churn
Slots disabled per household	≤ 1 of 5	If people are switching off prayers, something is intrusive
Contribution participation	≥ 50%	The institution's own economics are working

The last three are the ones that predict renewal six months ahead. They are available from day one and should be on the head's monthly report, not just ours.

Marketing and trust

There is no demand-generation problem to solve, because there is no searchable demand. Marketing here has one job: make an institution that hears about this from a peer feel safe proceeding.

What marketing actually produces

Asset	Purpose	Priority
Reach certificate	One page, signed, dated, per institution per quarter. Households enrolled, reached, broadcasts delivered	Highest — it is simultaneously the sales proof, the referral trigger and the CSR evidence
Case study, one per segment	A masjid, a parish, a funded institution. The head's own words, real numbers	High
Committee one-pager	What it is, what it costs, who pays in year three. Printed, local language	High
Demo kit	Portable, works without their network. The single most effective sales asset there is	High
Enrolment pack	Posters, desk forms, consent forms, volunteer scripts, household card	High — this is what activation runs on
Household card	Fridge-magnet sized: what the lights mean, who to call, how to change slots	Medium
Partner training material	Commissioning, triage, what not to promise	Medium
Funder deck and impact report format	Households reached, cost per household reached, verification method	High, from month six
Website	Credibility check, not lead generation. Who we are, who has deployed us, how to contact	Low but necessary

Notice what is absent: content marketing, paid acquisition, SEO, social media advertising. None of it reaches a committee, and the money is better spent on one more enrolment campaign.

Language and localisation

Everything household-facing and committee-facing in the local language, produced properly rather than machine-translated. This is a trust signal before it is a comprehension aid — a Malayalam or Urdu one-pager that reads naturally says more about whether we understand this community than any claim we could make in English.

The reputational lines

This venture operates at the intersection of religion, technology and a contested public-order issue. Three positions should be written down before the first press enquiry, and everyone including partners should know them.

On noise regulation. The channel is additive. The institution's loudspeaker and its permissions are entirely its own matter. We do not advise on compliance, we do not market against regulation, and we do not comment on individual disputes. Any partner or institution that positions us otherwise is corrected immediately.

On faith. We serve institutions of every faith on identical terms and identical pricing. By institution 25 there should be deployments across at least two faiths, because the first time a journalist asks, the answer needs to be a list rather than an assurance.

On data. We never sell, share or analyse household data. The box has no microphone — a hardware fact, not a policy. Published, plainly, in the local language, on the website and in the household card.

Press

Do not seek coverage before institution 25. A story about a startup helping mosques broadcast, written before there is a track record and a multi-faith deployment list, will be framed by someone else's agenda and will follow this venture permanently.

When the time comes, the story that works is the one about the 78-year-old who has not been able to walk to the mosque for six years and now hears the adhan in her own room. That story is true, it is the actual reason to build this, and it is legible to funders, committees and journalists alike.

Scaling across the country

District by district, not state by state. The unit of expansion is a district with three to five installer partners, one federation relationship and enough institutions to refer to each other — roughly **20 to 30 institutions**.

The district as the unit

Element	Why the district	Threshold
Installer partners	Their vans cover a taluk, not a state	3–5 per district
Referral network	Heads know each other within a district	8–10 live institutions before referral self-sustains
Field support travel	Under 90 minutes to any institution	—
Federation relationship	Dioceses and boards are organised regionally	1 per district or region
Language and materials	One language covers a district	One localisation per district cluster

Year by year

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4–5
Institutions live	5	100	250	600–800
Districts	1	4	10	25–30
States	1	1	2–3	5–6
Households reached	2,000	40,000	1,00,000	2,80,000
Installer partners	2	15	40	100+
Federation relationships	1	3	8	20
Revenue	₹2 L	₹25 L	₹85 L	₹2.5–3.5 Cr
Position	Pilot	Proof	Approaching break-even	Sustainable

Choosing the next district

In priority order: an existing federation relationship that spans into it; an installer partner already working there; broadband and smartphone penetration high enough to keep the T3 share under 20%; a language already localised; and institutions large enough — 300+ households — for the economics to work. A district that scores on four of five is a candidate; on two, it is a distraction.

What travels, and what has to be rebuilt

Travels unchanged	Needs local work
Platform, hardware, firmware	Language localisation of all materials
Pricing and packaging	Installer partner recruitment, 2–3 months lead
Enrolment campaign design	Federation relationship, 6–12 months lead
Partner training and certification	Reference institutions in that district
Commissioning runbook	Local timetable conventions and calculation methods
Funder reporting format	CSR relationships, often state-linked

Federation relationships and installer partners both need to be started roughly two to three quarters before the institutions are wanted. Expansion planning is therefore always one district ahead of expansion execution, and the commonest way this goes wrong is discovering in month one of a new district that there is nobody to install anything.

Crossing faiths and states

Moving from masjids to parishes within a district is mostly a channel problem — different federations, same installers, same product — and it is worth doing early for the positioning reasons already stated.

Moving between states is harder than it looks: new language, new CSR relationships, often new state-level regulatory temperament around loudspeakers, different broadband economics, and a federation network that does not cross the border. Treat a new state as a new market with its own 12-month ramp, not as an extension.

The thing that would change the shape entirely

If a state waqf board, a large diocese, or a state government department funded a block of 100+ institutions at once, the plan collapses from five years into two. It is worth pursuing deliberately — one such relationship is worth more than the entire direct sales effort — but the plan must stand up without it, because these conversations take years and most of them end in nothing.

Targets, KPIs and risks

The six numbers that matter

KPI	Year 1	Year 2	Why this one
Institutions live	5	100	The headline, and the least informative
Households reached per broadcast	1,700	34,000	The real product metric, and what funders buy
Reach rate (reached / enrolled)	≥ 90%	≥ 90%	If this falls, nothing else matters
Enrolment rate (enrolled / total households)	≥ 80%	≥ 85%	Predicts renewal and referral
Contribution participation	≥ 40%	≥ 55%	Whether institutions become self-funding
Institution renewal at 12 months	—	≥ 90%	The first real verdict on the business

Supporting: CAC by channel, referrals per live institution per year (target 0.5), installer partners active, days from approval to first broadcast (target ≤ 14), and cost per household reached per year — the number a CSR committee will compare against every other intervention it funds.

Commercial risks

#	Risk	L	I	Mitigation
M1	Inertia — the loudspeaker works, so nothing is urgent	High	High	Lead with reach and the household register, not continuity. Live demo in the first meeting. Funded first institutions to create local proof
M2	Enrolment underperforms and institutions quietly stop broadcasting	High	High	Enrolment campaign support sold as standard; managed first 90 days; volume-at-zero and dark-endpoint metrics watched from week one
M3	Grant and CSR funding does not arrive on schedule	Medium	High	Never fewer than three live funder conversations; stage hiring against confirmed capital; hardware ordered only against deposits
M4	Break-even proves further away than 220–360 institutions	Medium	High	Price test at institution 25; hold the team small; push field costs to partners early
M5	The product is politicised — framed as evading noise rules	Medium	Severe	Written positioning enforced with partners; multi-faith deployment by institution 25; no press before then; decline federations that want the political frame
M6	Installer partners oversell or serve badly	Medium	High	Certification covering what not to promise; joint attendance for a partner's first three; per-partner quality metrics
M7	Federation relationship consumes a year and delivers nothing	High	Medium	Time-boxed; never more than a third of pipeline; run all three channels in parallel

#	Risk	L	I	Mitigation
M8	Household contribution does not materialise, treasurers block renewals	Medium	High	Model works at 50% participation and ₹10; institution keeps 100% of what it collects; transparency reporting built in
M9	A data incident involving religious-community rosters	Low	Severe	Minimal data held; encryption and access control; institution is the fiduciary; breach plan written before launch
M10	A well-funded entrant copies the model	Low	Medium	The moat is trust, federation relationships and installed base, none of which is bought quickly. Speed in a district matters more than secrecy
M11	Hardware working capital squeezes cash at exactly the growth moment	High	High	Deposits before ordering; grant capital ring-fenced for hardware batches; monthly rather than quarterly ordering
M12	Regulatory change makes the voice tier unworkable	Low	Medium	Voice is 15% of households and disableable; migrate those households to boxes; get a telecom opinion before institution 10

The two that decide it

M1 and M2 are the business. Everything else is manageable. If institutions cannot be persuaded that a working loudspeaker is not enough, there is no market; and if the institutions that do buy cannot get 85% of their households enrolled, there is no renewal, no referral and no impact story to fund the next round.

Both are answered in the same place — the first five institutions. They should be over-supported to an extent that is not scalable and not profitable, because what they produce is the reach numbers, the case studies and the reference calls that every subsequent conversation depends on.

First decisions needed

#	Decision	By
G1	Which district, and which federation relationship to start	Month 1
G2	Entity structure — operating company and Section 8 arm	Month 2, before the first grant application
G3	Whether the first 5 institutions are fully funded, and from where	Month 2
G4	Subscription price confirmed or revised after institution 25	Month 15
G5	Second faith deployment target — which segment and when	Month 9